

	Review Rating	New Rating/200	New Rating/100
	85	152.0823952	76.04119761
	73	137.6511217	68.82556087
	84	161.8473518	80.92367591
	86	146.5209606	73.26048028
	81	138.2702105	69.13510526
	86	155.1360522	77.56802608
	81	131.8628897	65.93144483
	82	133.6312816	66.81564079
	81	142.6866848	71.3433424
	77	127.8467786	63.92338932
	77	141.0600669	70.53003344
	78	140.7974093	70.39870466
	60	129.7216017	64.86080085
	75	129.2257626	64.61288131
	74	117.8572991	58.92864956
	78	131.9107111	65.95535555
	75	123.4619365	61.73096826
	63	125.3514199	62.67570997

how much their price has depreciated in the time they've spent in the market.

If you've followed the market to any degree, you'll realise that Apple's iPhones drop prices slower than Samsung's flagship devices. This automatically makes the iPhone's resale value higher than most Android flagships. For example, in less than a year, the price of the Samsung Galaxy S6 has fallen by about 22 percent which is about 5 percent per month. Additionally, a phone such as the LG G4 has depreciated by about 6 percent. The iPhone 6 on the other hand, depreciated by about 2 percent per month.

However, depreciation counts less as you go down the price ladder. This is because when you spend smaller amounts on your smartphone, you're already looking to get less when selling it. For example, you won't really be looking to resell a used sub-₹7000 smartphone and get a lot of money would you?

What's worth considering though is that when a device such as the Moto E

(2nd Gen), which has a history of being a real value-for-money device, depreciates by 5% per month, it is a sure shot sign that it's not really selling very well. And one has to wonder why. The Moto E (2nd Gen) 4G was launched at ₹7,999, but it's currently selling for ₹1,000 lower in a matter of about four months.

Furthermore, products such as the OnePlus 2, tend to stay at their launch price longer than many others, considering that the company has already come up with a pretty competitive price, cutting its margins dearly. As a result, the price of a OnePlus One has depreciated by only about 18% in the eight-odd months that it's spent in India. With the OnePlus 2, the company has held strong for the first couple of months, and we don't expect the pricing to drop permanently any time soon. The Xiaomi Mi 4 on the other hand had met with tough competition in the market and the company drastically dropped its price pretty soon. That's not good for someone who bought the phone at the original price, considering that the 16GB Mi 4 currently sells at only ₹14,999, down from the original pricing of around ₹20,000. Note that we're considering only official and permanent price drops here, and not temporary offer prices.

Apple iPhone 6 has dropped to sub-₹40,000 after almost a full year of being in the market, while Samsung's Galaxy S6 did so in less than six months. This gave the iPhone a lot of points over the Galaxy S6.

RETURN ON INVESTMENT

There are two reasons why return on sale is important. The first is a continuation of what we discussed about depreciation above, but the second is arguably more important. At the rate at which people dispose off their smartphones these days, e-waste is a genuine problem. So, selling your smartphone to a refurbishing unit is the best way to go. We considered Reglobe, in and Atterobay, two of the best known companies in this business. We verified the prices they offer for one year old units of our top ten smartphones, when they're in reasonably good condition.

Of course, many would prefer selling their current phone to someone instead of recycling, which is also not a bad idea. Therefore, we considered an average of the prices these two websites offered,

thereby obtaining an adjusted sale price for each product. The idea being that you will use your phone for at least a full year before thinking about buying your next smartphone.

Of course, the higher the price that you can get, the better. Like depreciation, the return on investment is also more important for the more expensive products. When you're spending above ₹30,000 on a smartphone, that's a substantial sum, and you would hope to get as much of your money back as possible.

A surprising fact that we came across here is that Atterobay seems to be willing to pay more for a one year old Galaxy S6 in good condition, than a similarly aged iPhone 6 (16GB) also in a similar condition. If you bought a Galaxy S6 at its launch price of nearly ₹50,000, you may be able to get back nearly 40 percent of your money by selling it a year later. The iPhone 6 came a close second with 36 percent.

Note that we're only trying to draw examples here, of how things happen, and what you should consider. When buying an inexpensive phone, you should check websites like Reglobe and Attero to gain an idea of what you can expect later. While it will be difficult to determine these aspects for phones that have just been launched, checking what happened with older devices is a good idea to know the company's history. For example, the iPhone 6 serves as a good proxy for the just launched iPhone 6S, while the OnePlus One does the same for the OnePlus 2.

AVAILABILITY

Do you know how often we see angry consumers writing the choicest of words for OnePlus and its invite system on our Facebook page? The same also happens for the flash sales model introduced by Xiaomi, and followed by many now. A good phone should be available right? Not just that, there's also the online vs offline factor. You may be comfortable spending ₹7,000 on a smartphone online, but when it comes to spending ₹60,000 for an iPhone, you'd prefer to physically see the phone before you buy it. No?

Further, what happens when a phone you really want is available only on one e-commerce website and that website doesn't deliver to your location? The online vs offline debate is a long one,